

Smith v. Johnson Family Custody Dispute

This matter comes before the court regarding the custody arrangement of minor children following the dissolution of marriage between petitioner Sarah Smith and respondent Michael Johnson. The parties were married on June 15, 2010, and have two minor children, ages 8 and 5. The petitioner seeks primary physical custody with joint legal custody. The court has considered the best interests of the children, including their relationship with each parent, the stability of each home environment, and the children's educational and emotional needs. Evidence presented includes testimony from both parents, a custody evaluation report, and statements from the children's teachers and counselors. After careful consideration of all evidence and applicable law, the court finds that joint legal custody with primary physical custody to the petitioner serves the best interests of the minor children. The respondent shall have parenting time every other weekend and one evening per week. Both parties shall participate in co-parenting counseling to facilitate effective communication regarding the children's welfare. Child support shall be calculated according to state guidelines based on the parties' respective incomes. The respondent shall maintain health insurance for the minor children and both parties shall share unreimbursed medical expenses equally.